

BHOPAL | Precious Boycott

CHOUHAN (CENTRE)

It was designed as a showpiece event to translate Chief Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan's vision statement, Swarnim (Golden) Madhya Pradesh, into reality. The Opposition Congress, however, poured cold water over the special session of the state Assembly, calling it an "un-constitutional" idea. The Congress Legislature Party confirmed its boycott despite Chouhan sending a letter to Congress chief Sonia Gandhi, urging her to ask the legislators to attend the session. The boycott not only exposed the state Government's poor floor management, but also its failure to take the Congress into confidence before embarking on such an ambitious exercise. The Opposition, too, missed a trick—now it won't have the opportunity to pick holes in Chouhan's governance.

by Ambresh Mishra

PANKAJ TIWARI/www.indiatodayimages.com

DELHI | Year to the Ground

IN THE PAST ONE WEEK, MANMOHAN HAD TO DEAL WITH THREE MINISTERIAL EMBARRASMENTS.

Three ministerial embarrassments in a week is not what Prime Minister Manmohan Singh needs during UPA-II's first anniversary. Environment Minister Jairam Ramesh had to be pulled up for ignoring his boss' order not to meddle in other ministries, that too from foreign soil. Then the Government had to explain Mamata Banerjee's absence in Parliament during a discussion on the Mumbai rail strike. Taped conversations between lobbyist Neera Radia and Telecom Minister A. Raja have now led to a new storm. Manmohan could not reprimand Banerjee or Raja as they are allies. Coalition maths spawns unequal equations.

by Priya Sahgal

MUMBAI | Cabbies in the Net

Within four months of taking charge, Maharashtra's high-tech transport commissioner Dilip Jadhav has found a novel way out to crack down on Mumbai's rude cabbies and auto drivers. He has asked complaints to be directly e-mailed to him and says the complaint will be processed in three days. Action could be taken over 40 offences, including refusal to ply short distances, excess fare, rude behaviour or fake tariff cards. Jadhav has also proposed setting up a high-tech control room which would provide a 24-hour helpline for taxi and auto commuters. Around five lakh passengers ride on 1.6 lakh taxis and autos each day.

by Nishika Patel



SAURABH SINGH/www.indiatodayimages.com

DELHI | Clean List

Chandigarh has come clean—at least the Government thinks so. In the exhaustive list of 423 cities ranked under the National Rating Exercise in sanitation undertaken in

Chandigarh (PUNJAB)

Mysore (KARNATAKA)

Surat (GUJARAT)

New Delhi (DELHI)

Delhi Cantt. (DELHI)

Tiruchirapalli (TAMIL NADU)

Jamshedpur (JHARKHAND)

Mangalore (KARNATAKA)

Rajkot (GUJARAT)

Kanpur (UP)

TOP 10 CITIES

WORST 10 CITIES

Sultanpur (UP)

Darbhanga (BIHAR)

Saharsa (BIHAR)

Badaun (UP)

Motihari (BIHAR)

Jhunjhunu (RAJASTHAN)

Srinagar (J&K)

Pilibhit (UP)

Lakhimpur (UP)

Churu (RAJASTHAN)

2009, Corbusiergarh is the most sanitised city while Churu in Rajasthan is the least sanitised. This is the first-ever exercise conducted by the government under its National Urban Sanitation Policy, announced in October 2008.

by Nivedita Mukherjee